

Chicago Tribune



QUESTIONS? CALL 1-800-TRIBUNE

SATURDAY, SEPTEMBER 27, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

TRUMP’S CHICAGO TAKEOVER

Feds escalate in standoff



A federal agent points his rifle of pepper balls at a protester near the U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement facility on Friday in Broadview. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Agents fire baton rounds at Broadview protesters; lawmakers request meeting with ICE office chief

By **Caroline Kubzansky and Madeline Buckley**
Chicago Tribune

Federal agents fired baton rounds, tear gas and other less-lethal ammunition Friday morning at about 200 people gathered outside an U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement holding facility in Broadview to protest the Trump administration’s continued crackdown on illegal immigration.

The standoff marked the third consecutive Friday in which agents and protesters have faced off outside the west suburban facility, where the agency holds

recently detained immigrants in the U.S. without legal permission. The building has become a flash point for opponents of “Operation Midway Blitz,” which Department of Homeland Security officials say has resulted in more than 550 arrests in the Chicago area, and a place for political opponents of the Trump administration to see and be seen protesting.

The federal government erected a large metal fence around the low-slung brick building earlier this week after protests on Sept. 19 resulted in agents hurling copious

Turn to ICE, Page 2

Trump administration’s threat to send in National Guard under guise of fighting crime taps into traumas long held by Chicago’s Black community



HISTORIC TENSION, PRESENT-DAY FEAR

By **Darcel Rockett and Tess Kenny** | Chicago Tribune

Jadah Parker is on edge these days. The 26-year-old is cautious while commuting from her Washington Park apartment to work in the Loop. She keeps a lock on the driving wheel of her car, and is usually indoors by the time the sun sets. But with talk that President Donald Trump might deploy the National Guard to Chicago, Parker, who is Black, has been reminding herself to stay on her best behavior. “It just makes me completely nervous,” she said.

Since sending the National Guard to Los Angeles and Washington, D.C., earlier this year, Trump has repeatedly threatened to deploy troops to Chicago under

the guise of combating crime — despite the fact that, according to city and county figures, Chicago was poised to close the first half of the year with its steepest

statistical drop in crime in recent memory.

But as Trump toys with the idea of militarizing some of the country’s most Democratic cities — in turn, testing the limits of presidential power — the idea of increased law enforcement patrolling the city’s neighborhoods weighs heavily on Chicago’s Black communities, whose relationship with law enforcement is rooted in historical tensions and present-day fear.

For residents of primarily Black neighborhoods on the South and West sides, terms like “Operation Midway Blitz,” “Death Trap,” “Chipocalypse Now” — all phrases the Trump administration has used when talking about Chicago amid

Turn to Trauma, Page 4

Jadah Parker, a lifelong Chicagoan, stands outside her home in the Washington Park neighborhood on Wednesday. With federal immigration agents crawling across the city, Parker said the situation is nerve-wracking. **JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Comey charges raising alarms

Case likely deepens fear DOJ is targeting Trump adversaries

By **Jill Colvin**
Associated Press

NEW YORK — President Donald Trump cheered the indictment of James Comey, the former FBI director, and predicted Friday that more indictments are on the way, even as he denied that he has a list of perceived enemies he wants to see prosecuted.

“It’s about justice, really. It’s not revenge, it’s about justice,” Trump told reporters on the South Lawn of the White House.

“It’s also about the fact that you can’t let this go on. They are sick, radical left people and they can’t get away with it.”

Asked who is next on his list, he responded: “It’s not a list, but I think there’ll be others.”

The indictment makes Comey the first former senior government official involved in one of Trump’s chief grievances, the long-concluded investigation into Russian interference in the 2016 election, to face prosecution. Trump has for years derided that investigation as a “hoax” and a “witch hunt” despite multiple government reviews showing that Moscow interfered on behalf of the Republican’s campaign, and has made clear his desire for retribution.

The criminal case is likely to deepen concerns that the Justice Department under the leadership of Attorney General Pam Bondi is being weaponized as it pursues investigations of public figures the president regards as his adversaries.

Indicating a wide-ranging retribution crusade against his political opponents, the president had directed Bondi, in writing, to move more quickly to prosecute individuals he considers his enemies.

Turn to Comey, Page 6

CHICAGO SPORTS



CHRIS SWEDA/TRIBUNE

Rout of Cards has Cubs sighing relief

After feeling pressure amid a losing skid earlier this week, Seiya Suzuki, above, and the Cubs are finally on the precipice of clinching home field in the wild-card series, writes columnist Paul Sullivan.

Abortion providers brace for influx amid pause in Wisconsin

By **Angie Leventis Lourgos**
Chicago Tribune

Illinois abortion providers say they’re preparing for a surge of out-of-state patients after Planned Parenthood of Wisconsin announced a pause on termi-

nations starting next week, as the nonprofit grapples with Medicaid funding cuts in President Donald Trump’s tax and spending bill.

The move is the latest challenge to abortion access in neighboring Wisconsin, where the legality of ending a pregnancy — and avail-

ability of abortion care — has been in flux since the U.S. Supreme Court overturned Roe v Wade in 2022.

Each time abortion is halted or restricted there, waves of abortion seekers cross state lines into Illinois, which has long been known

as an oasis of reproductive rights in the increasingly restrictive Midwest.

While local abortion clinics and reproductive health advocates believe they’ll be able to handle the anticipated flood of Wisconsin patients, they’re worried about

capacity long-term as funding for abortion providers remains under siege nationwide.

“With the sharp reduction in abortion access expected in Wisconsin in less than a week, we

Turn to Abortion, Page 2

